Ali Macapado Tabao

Engr. Ali M. Tabao is a name that quietly carries a lot of weight in Marawi City's public service circles, and once you look at his record, it's easy to see why. He has spent more than four decades working inside the government agencies devoted to Muslim Filipino affairs, and in 2026 that long climb reached its peak when President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr. appointed him **Regional Director of the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF) Marawi Regional Office.** That kind of tenure is rare anywhere, and it says something about a man who built his entire working life around one mission: serving his own community from the inside.

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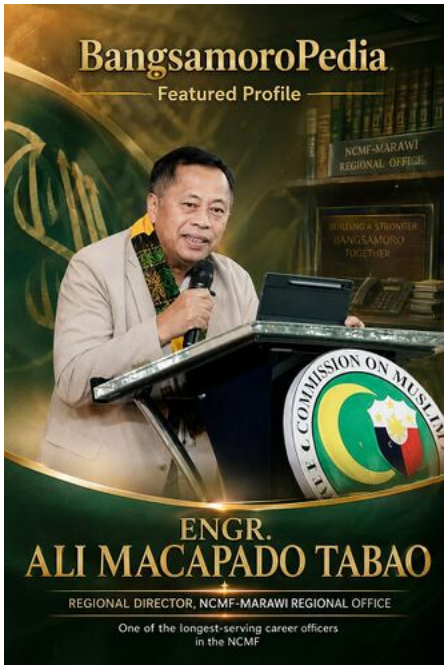
Early Life and Family

Ali Macapado Tabao was born on October 2, 1963, in Marawi City, and he has never really left. His residential and permanent address both trace back to the same neighborhood in Marawi, a detail that fits a man who has stayed rooted in the place where he grew up. He is Maranao, a Filipino citizen, and married to **Farnaida Tanggol Taba**o (rahimahallah), who runs her own business out of Saduc, Marawi City. Together they raised five children, several of whom are now adults building their own paths: T**asneem, Ameer Fahad, Mohammad Ali, Taheema Najmus Sahar, and Neezam**, all carrying the Tanggol Tabao name. His parents were **Mustapha Karic Tabao** and **Zainab Macapado Tabao**, and it's worth noting that Ali's own record traces cleanly back to a Marawi household that valued both faith and hard work.

Education

Ali's schooling followed a path familiar to many Maranao professionals of his generation: local roots first, then Manila for the technical training. He attended Camp Keitly Elementary School from 1969 to 1974, then moved on to Lanao National College of Arts and

Engr. Ali M. Tabao



Full Name
Ali Macapado Tabao
Born
October 2, 1963
Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Ethnicity
Maranao
Residence
Marawi City, Lanao del Sur
Occupation
Regional Director, National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF) Marawi Regional Office (formerly Development Management Officer III)
Profession
Licensed Civil Engineer (PRC License No. 042953-96)
Alma Mater
Manuel L. Quezon University (BS Civil Engineering, 1985)
Lanao National College of Arts and Trade (Secondary, 1979)
Camp Keitly Elementary School (1974)
Years of Government Service
1984 to present (40+ years)
Spouse
Farnaida Tanggol Tabao
Children

Trade for his secondary education, finishing in 1979. From there he headed to Manuel L. Quezon University, where he earned his **Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering, graduating in 1985**. No honors or scholarships are noted for either stage of his schooling, but the degree itself set the stage for everything that came after.

Civil Engineering License

The same year he graduated, Ali sat for the Civil Engineering Board Examination, passing it on May 1, 1985, at Far Eastern University with a rating of 70.50 percent. He holds Professional Regulation Commission license number 042953-96, and he has kept that license active for decades, a detail that matters because it shows he never let go of his engineering identity even as his government career pulled him deeper into administrative and community work.

Career in Public Service

Ali's government career began in 1984 as a casual Engineer Aide at the Department of Public Works and Highways, earning a modest 990 pesos a month. By August 1986 he had moved to the Office on Muslim Affairs, taking on the role of Development Management Officer II under a temporary appointment. He was promoted to Senior Development Management Officer in 1987, and by July 1989 he had settled into the position he would hold, in one form or another, for the rest of his career: Development Management Officer III.

That position carried him through the agency's transformation from the old Office on Muslim Affairs into the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos, and his salary records trace a steady, uninterrupted climb from 5,670 pesos a month in 1989 to over 55,000 pesos a month by 2025, all under Salary Grade 18. What stands out isn't just the length of service but the consistency of it: no gaps, no resignations, no breaks in the record, just one continuous thread of public service stretching back to the mid-1980s.

That thread reached a new milestone in 2026, when President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr. appointed him **Regional Director of the NCMF Marawi Regional Office**, elevating him from the Development Management Officer III post he had held since 1989. In this expanded role, his work continues to touch programs that matter deeply to the Maranao and broader Muslim Filipino community, **from Hajj coordination to Halal certification awareness to cooperative development**, now carried out under his direct regional leadership.

Civic and Professional Involvement

Outside his government post, Ali has stayed active in a handful of organizations that reflect both his professional identity and his personal interests. He has been a member of the Philippine Institute of Civil Engineers since June 8, 1985, keeping that connection alive for essentially his entire career. He also belongs to the Marawi Tennis Club (since 1996), the Marawi Association of Motorists Group (since 2001), and the Achievers Badminton Club (since

Tasneem; Ameer Fahad, Mohammad Ali; Taheema Najmus Sahar; Neezam.

Parents

Mustapha Karic Tabao (father)
Zainab Macapado Tabao (mother)

Affiliations

Philippine Institute of Civil Engineers
Marawi Tennis Club
Marawi Association of Motorists Group
Achievers Badminton Club

Notability

One of the longest-serving career officers in the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos, having risen from casual Engineer Aide to Regional Director over four decades, an appointment made by President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr. in 2026 that capped a career spent almost entirely within the agency tasked with Muslim Filipino affairs.

Known For

Steering technical and community programs out of the NCMF Marawi Regional Office, including Hajj coordination, Halal awareness, cooperative development, and Islamic finance training, while keeping his civil engineering license active and in good standing throughout his public service career.

Pull Quote

"Forty years in the same house of service, one engineer who never stopped showing up for Marawi."

2008), memberships that hint at a man who balances desk work with an active lifestyle. His hobbies, by his own account, include tennis, badminton, and basketball, alongside basic computer literacy, a useful skill for a civil servant navigating decades of shifting office technology.

Training and Continuing Development

Few civil servants can point to a training record as dense as Ali's. Across the past two decades alone, his Personal Data Sheet lists dozens of seminars, workshops, and conventions, ranging from technical civil engineering conferences with PICE to NCMF-run programs on Islamic finance, Halal awareness, cooperative fundamentals, disaster preparedness, and peacebuilding. Recent entries include the 2025 Hajj Awareness Program in January 2025 and the 50th Philippine Institute of Civil Engineers National Convention in October 2024, both attended just months before his Personal Data Sheet was signed. Earlier entries stretch back through pandemic-era webinars on CSC rules and mental health support, community legal education programs, and sessions on preventing and countering violent extremism, a training history that reads almost like a timeline of what mattered most to Muslim Filipino communities over the past several years.

Personal Standing

According to his own disclosures, Ali has never faced an administrative case, a criminal charge, or a conviction of any kind, and he has never been separated from government service through resignation, dismissal, or similar means. He has also never run for national or local elective office outside of barangay-level contests, keeping his record squarely on the civil service side of Philippine public life.

Taken together, the record paints a picture of a Maranao professional who chose one lane early in life, civil engineering in service of Muslim Filipino affairs, and stayed in it for more than forty years without wavering, a patience that was rewarded in 2026 with his appointment as Regional Director. That kind of quiet, sustained commitment doesn't always make headlines, but it's exactly the sort of career that keeps institutions like NCMF running in places like Marawi.

References

1. National Commission on Muslim Filipinos, Personal Data Sheet of Ali Macapado Tabao, signed January 25, 2025.
2. Appointment as Regional Director, National Commission on Muslim Filipinos Marawi Regional Office, by President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr., 2026 (editorial update, supplementary to the 2025 Personal Data Sheet).

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